THE PAPER 1: MEDICINE THROUGH TIME WITH THE WESTERN FRONT DOSSIER: RENAISSANCE

77 Crucial Questions. Complete Knowledge Mastery.

Operative / Student Name: ____________________________
Target: Total Recall

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- 🟩 **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- 🟨 **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- 🟥 **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

KT2.1: Did the Renaissance change beliefs about the causes of illness?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	What does the French word 'Renaissance' translate to, and what did it represent in medical history?	☐	☐	☐	
2	How did the rise of Protestantism during the Reformation affect the Church's influence over scientific and medical learning in the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
3	How did Johannes Gutenberg's printing press (developed in around 1440) directly support progress in medical knowledge during the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
4	Why was the 17th-century English physician Thomas Sydenham known as the 'English Hippocrates'?	☐	☐	☐	
5	How did Thomas Sydenham's view of disease fundamentally challenge the traditional Theory of the Four Humours?	☐	☐	☐	
6	Which two diseases did Thomas Sydenham successfully distinguish and classify as separate illnesses in his clinical observation work?	☐	☐	☐	
7	What was the primary objective of the Royal Society, which was founded in London in the year 1660?	☐	☐	☐	
8	What was the official Latin motto of the Royal Society, and what did it encourage scientists to do?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
9	What was the name of the Royal Society's scientific journal, first published in 1665, which allowed scientists to share and peer-review research globally?	☐	☐	☐	
10	In 1683, Antony van Leeuwenhoek used an improved microscope to observe 'animalcules' (bacteria) for the first time. What was the major limitation of this breakthrough in the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
11	Why did Renaissance physicians continue to use the Theory of the Four Humours when diagnosing patients, despite many doctors beginning to doubt its scientific accuracy by the late 17th century?	☐	☐	☐	
12	How did beliefs about 'miasma' change during the Medical Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
13	Andreas Vesalius's anatomical dissections proved that Galen had made over 200 mistakes. Why did this breakthrough have almost no immediate impact on everyday medical treatments?	☐	☐	☐	
14	Which of the following was a revolutionary treatment for smallpox developed by Thomas Sydenham that directly challenged traditional medieval practices?	☐	☐	☐	
15	What was the 'Royal Touch' and what did its popularity during the Renaissance demonstrate about society's beliefs?	☐	☐	☐	
16	What intellectual movement in the Renaissance period encouraged people to think for themselves, ask questions, and use observation to find the truth?	☐	☐	☐	
17	How did the training of physicians in universities begin	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	to improve during the Renaissance?				
18	In what way did the printing press improve scientific accuracy in medical research compared to manual copying by medieval monks?	☐	☐	☐	
19	What popular New World herbal remedy, imported from Peru, did Thomas Sydenham popularise to treat malaria (ague)?	☐	☐	☐	
20	Which of the following statements best summarises the progress made in ideas about the causes of disease between 1500 and 1700?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: ______ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): ________________________

Date: ______

KT2.1: Did the Renaissance change beliefs about the causes of illness?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	In what year did the Black Death arrive in England?	☐	☐	☐	
22	What did medieval people believe caused the Black Death?	☐	☐	☐	
23	State one method used to try to prevent the Black Death.	☐	☐	☐	
24	Why did the Black Death cause such a high death toll?	☐	☐	☐	
25	To what extent did the Black Death change medical ideas?	☐	☐	☐	
26	Recall: Who was Claudius Galen and what was their key contribution to medicine?	☐	☐	☐	
27	What is the primary reason why Andreas Vesalius's major Renaissance breakthroughs in anatomy did not immediately improve everyday medical treatments for patients?	☐	☐	☐	
28	Which of the following treatments represents a major CONTINUITY in everyday medical practice between the Medieval period and the Medical Renaissance (c1500–c1700)?	☐	☐	☐	
29	What was the new Renaissance medical theory of 'transference', and how was it practically applied by patients?	☐	☐	☐	
30	How did exploration of the 'New World' (the Americas) change herbal medicine in Renaissance England?	☐	☐	☐	
31	What was the medical term 'iatrochemistry' (or alchemy), which became increasingly popular during the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
32	Why did the chemical element antimony become a controversial treatment during the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
33	Which major political event in 1536 had a devastating immediate impact on hospital care and charity beds across England?	☐	☐	☐	
34	Following the Dissolution of the Monasteries in 1536, what major change occurred in how surviving hospitals were funded and run?	☐	☐	☐	
35	How did the primary focus of hospitals shift during the Renaissance compared to their medieval predecessors?	☐	☐	☐	
36	How did the London city council and local charity manage to keep St Bartholomew's Hospital open after 1536?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What were 'Pest Houses' and why were they introduced during the Renaissance period?	☐	☐	☐	
38	If a Renaissance patient suffered from a disease that produced a red skin rash, such as smallpox, what traditional herbal-associative treatment would they most likely receive?	☐	☐	☐	
39	What was a major change in the medical staff employed by municipal hospitals like St Bartholomew's during the late Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
40	Why did everyday people in Renaissance England continue to rely on traditional family treatments in the home rather than municipal hospitals or professional physicians?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _______ / 20

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KT2.2: Did treatments improve during the Renaissance?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	Which of the following is a classic example of iatrochemistry/alchemy used as an everyday treatment in the late 1600s, showing the dangerous nature of some Renaissance medical experiments?	☐	☐	☐	
42	How did the role of professional guilds, such as the Company of Barber-Surgeons, affect medical training during the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
43	How did the treatment of plague victims in the 1665 Great Plague demonstrate continuity with the 1348 Black Death?	☐	☐	☐	
44	Why did people in the 1500s and 1600s begin to take fewer warm baths, representing a decline in hygiene compared to the medieval period?	☐	☐	☐	
45	What did King Charles II's final medical treatment in 1685 (such as opening veins for bleeding and purging his bowels) demonstrate about the state of royal medicine at the end of the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
46	Which statement best describes the overall pace of change in medical TREATMENTS during the Medical Renaissance (c1500–c1700)?	☐	☐	☐	
47	What was the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What invention helped spread new medical ideas during the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	
49	Who was Thomas Sydenham?	☐	☐	☐	
50	Why did the influence of the Church begin to decline in the Renaissance?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
51	Explain why the Theory of the Four Humours was still used despite new discoveries.	☐	☐	☐	
52	In his landmark 1628 publication, An Anatomical Account of the Motion of the Heart and Blood, what did William Harvey empirically prove about the human body?	☐	☐	☐	
53	Which mechanical technology of the 17th century did William Harvey use as a scientific analogy to explain how the heart's valves function?	☐	☐	☐	
54	Which ancient authority's medical teachings did William Harvey's work on the circulatory system directly contradict and disprove?	☐	☐	☐	
55	Why did William Harvey's discovery of blood circulation have almost no immediate impact on everyday medical treatments in the short term?	☐	☐	☐	
56	How did the English medical establishment initially react to William Harvey's publication in 1628?	☐	☐	☐	
57	How long did it take for William Harvey's discoveries about blood circulation to be officially adopted into the medical curriculum at English universities?	☐	☐	☐	
58	What vital scientific limitation prevented William Harvey from fully explaining how blood traveled from the arteries back into the veins?	☐	☐	☐	
59	In the long term, why was William Harvey's breakthrough in physiology so significant for modern medicine?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
60	How did the mortality rate of the 1665 Great Plague in London compare to the 1348 Black Death in England?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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KT2.3: How significant were William Harvey and the Great Plague?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	What was the most significant difference in the government and municipal response to the 1665 Great Plague compared to the 1348 Black Death?	☐	☐	☐	
62	If a London household had a member diagnosed with the Great Plague in 1665, what quarantine measure was legally enforced by watchmen?	☐	☐	☐	
63	What was the specific, dangerous duty of the municipal officials known as 'searchers' during the Great Plague of 1665?	☐	☐	☐	
64	Why did London authorities order the mass slaughter of roughly 40,000 dogs and cats in 1665, and what was the unintended consequence?	☐	☐	☐	
65	Which of the following was a preventative measure enforced by municipal authorities in London in 1665 to limit the spread of the plague?	☐	☐	☐	
66	How did municipal authorities organize the burial of plague victims in 1665 to minimize the risk of miasma?	☐	☐	☐	
67	Why did both medieval mayors in 1348 and Renaissance mayors in 1665 order giant barrels of tar and bonfires to be burned in the streets?	☐	☐	☐	
68	What was the believed physical purpose of the bird-shaped beak mask worn by Renaissance 'plague doctors'?	☐	☐	☐	
69	Which bizarre, superstitious treatment recorded during the 1665 Great Plague demonstrates	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	the complete lack of improvement in medical cures since 1348?				
70	Why were schoolboys at Eton College severely punished or beaten if they refused to smoke tobacco during the Great Plague of 1665?	☐	☐	☐	
71	What does the continued use of amulets, carrying pomanders, and humoural bleeding during the Great Plague of 1665 demonstrate about Renaissance medicine?	☐	☐	☐	
72	Who wrote 'On the Fabric of the Human Body' (1543)?	☐	☐	☐	
73	What did Vesalius prove about Galen's anatomical ideas?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What was 'transference'?	☐	☐	☐	
75	Explain how hospitals changed during the Renaissance.	☐	☐	☐	
76	Why did Vesalius' discoveries have limited immediate impact on everyday medical treatment?	☐	☐	☐	
77	Recall: Who was Andreas Vesalius and what was their key contribution to medicine?	☐	☐	☐	

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT2.1: Did the Renaissance change beliefs about the causes of illness?

1. Rebirth; a period of reborn interest in classical worlds combined with a love of enquiry and a willingness to challenge old ideas
2. It made the Catholic Church much less able to promote and enforce its preferred beliefs about science and nature
3. It allowed new, controversial discoveries to be printed rapidly and shared cheaply, making it harder for the Church to censor or block them
4. Because he urged doctors to stop relying blindly on classical books and instead closely observe their patients' symptoms to diagnose them
5. He argued that diseases were separate, independent 'species' that could be grouped and classified like plants, rather than being unique to each individual's humoural balance
6. Measles and Scarlet Fever
7. To encourage scientific enquiry, promote empirical experimentation, and provide a hub for scientists to share their research
8. 'Nullius in verba' (Take nobody's word for it); it encouraged scientists to do experiments to prove things rather than just trusting classical authorities
9. Philosophical Transactions
10. He did not realise that these 'animalcules' actually caused illnesses, meaning spontaneous generation and miasma remained the dominant beliefs
11. Because patients fully understood the humoural system, and physicians had to respect their clients' expectations to earn a living
12. The belief in miasma remained highly popular and became even more widespread during devastating epidemics like the Great Plague of 1665
13. Because knowing the correct structure of the bones and organs did not give doctors new cures, so they continued to use traditional bleeding and herbal remedies
14. Prescribing airy bedrooms, light blankets, and cold drinks instead of the traditional 'sweating' method
15. The belief that the monarch could cure skin diseases like scrofula simply by touching the patient, demonstrating how slowly traditional and supernatural beliefs changed
16. Humanism
17. Students began to observe real human dissections alongside classical texts, using highly accurate printed anatomical illustrations
18. It guaranteed that every copy of a medical book contained identical, error-free text and precise anatomical drawings

19. Cinchona bark (quinine)
20. New anatomical knowledge and clinical observations laid vital foundations for the future, but everyday medical beliefs and treatments for the general public changed very little
21. 1348.
22. A punishment from God, an unusual alignment of planets, or miasma (bad air).
23. Carrying sweet-smelling herbs, lighting fires, or running away.
24. People did not understand germs or how the disease was actually transmitted (fleas on rats), so their prevention methods were entirely ineffective.
25. It caused very little immediate change; the sheer scale of the disaster reinforced reliance on religion and existing theories, as physicians had no better explanations.
26. Claudius Galen was a Ancient Roman Physician. Developed the Theory of Opposites based on the Four Humours. His anatomical writings, though often based on animal dissection and highly flawed, were promoted by the Catholic Church and formed the absolute basis of medical training for over 1,000 years.
27. Knowing the correct structure of bones and organs did not give doctors new chemical cures or treatments, so they continued to use traditional bleeding and purging
28. The continued reliance on bloodletting and purging to balance the Four Humours
29. The belief that an illness could be transferred to another object or animal, such as rubbing an onion on warts
30. It introduced new, effective herbal ingredients like cinchona bark (quinine) to treat malaria
31. The search for chemical and mineral-based cures (using metals like antimony) rather than plant-based remedies
32. Because in large doses it promoted sweating and vomiting to clear the body, but in small doses it was used as a daily general tonic
33. Henry VIII's Dissolution of the Monasteries
34. They transitioned from monastic control to being run and funded by secular town councils and charities
35. They shifted from providing general hospitality and spiritual 'care' to actively treating wounds and curable physical illnesses
36. By petitioning Henry VIII, who re-founded the hospital himself under municipal control in 1546
37. Specialized, secular isolation hospitals opened by town councils specifically to quarantine people suffering from highly contagious diseases like the plague
38. The 'red cure,' which involved drinking red wine, eating red foods, and wearing red clothing
39. They began employing university-trained physicians to actively treat and cure patients' physical conditions
40. Because physicians were extremely expensive, and mothers, wives, or local wise women provided familiar, free, and accessible herbal care

KT2.2: Did treatments improve during the Renaissance?

41. Prescribing ingredients derived from metals and minerals, such as mercury to treat syphilis, or using 'cold deadman's skull' in remedies
42. They helped to professionalize surgeons by regulating training through apprenticeships, separating their work from simple hair cutting
43. Both outbreaks were treated with humoural remedies (bleeding and purging), herbal mixtures, and prayers, because the cause (germs) was still unknown
44. Because public bath houses became associated with the rapid spread of the 'Great Pox' (syphilis), making people terrified of catching it
45. That despite monumental scientific discoveries, clinical medicine at the bedside remained heavily based on traditional, medieval humoural treatments
46. Treatments remained highly traditional with immense continuity, as the new scientific discoveries in anatomy and physiology did not yet translate into practical bedside cures
47. A period of 'rebirth' in art, science, and learning, beginning in the 15th century, which encouraged challenging old ideas.
48. The printing press.
49. An English physician known as the 'English Hippocrates', who believed in closely observing symptoms rather than relying on ancient books.
50. The Reformation and new scientific discoveries (like the Royal Society) encouraged people to look for rational explanations rather than purely religious ones.
51. It remained because there was no new, comprehensive theory of disease to replace it, and physicians still wanted to offer patients explanations.
52. That the heart acts as a muscular pump circulating blood continuously around the body in a one-way system
53. A fire-fighting water pump
54. Galen's theory that the liver constantly manufactures new blood
55. Knowing that blood circulated did not cure diseases, so physicians continued to use traditional bleeding and purging
56. Many doctors openly criticized or ignored him because his theory had no practical application at the bedside
57. It took nearly 50 years, with his ideas only regularly appearing in university medical lectures from around 1673
58. Microscopes of the era were not powerful enough to see the tiny capillaries linking arteries and veins
59. It served as the essential foundation for subsequent surgical developments, blood transfusions, and cardiology
60. The Great Plague killed roughly 15% of London's population (about 100,000 people), whereas the 1348 Black Death killed nearly 30-50% of the entire country

KT2.3: How significant were William Harvey and the Great Plague?

61. In 1665, local authorities implemented highly organized, centralized regulations enforced by watchmen and searchers
62. The house was boarded up with the entire family locked inside for 28 days, marked with a red cross on the door
63. To inspect homes, identify plague victims, confirm the cause of death, and monitor the spread
64. They believed the animals spread the plague through their breath, but killing them allowed the rat population (which carried the plague-carrying fleas) to explode
65. Banning large public gatherings, closing theatres, and locking down taverns
66. Bodies were collected in carts only at night and buried in deep, mass graves (plague pits) outside the city walls
67. To purify the air and drive away the disease-carrying 'bad air' (miasma)
68. They believed birds attracted the plague, so the mask would draw the disease away from the patient and into the herb-filled beak
69. Strapping a live, plucked chicken to a swollen plague bubo to draw out the poison
70. Tobacco smoke was believed to act as a powerful chemical shield to ward off the deadly plague miasma
71. That without an understanding of germs, people's fundamental beliefs about what caused the plague had not changed since 1348
72. Andreas Vesalius.
73. He proved that Galen had made over 300 mistakes because Galen had dissected animals, not humans (e.g., the human jawbone is one bone, not two).
74. The Renaissance belief that an illness or disease could be transferred to an object, animal, or another person.
75. Following the dissolution of the monasteries, many hospital-like institutions closed, leading to a shift towards secular funding, though they still largely focused on care rather than cure.
76. Knowing exactly where bones and organs were did not help physicians cure diseases, as they still didn't understand what caused illness.
77. Andreas Vesalius was a Pioneering Anatomist. A Renaissance physician who published "On the Fabric of the Human Body" (1543). By performing his own human dissections, he proved over 300 errors in Galen's work (e.g., proving the human jaw bone is one piece, not two).

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 77 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/77)	Parent/Guardian Signature	Target for Next Time
1				
2				
3				

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...